

STEADFAST

M E N

The Steadfast Way

A Workbook for Steadfast Men

NAME _____

WES HART

STEADFAST

MEN

SESSION 1

A Quiet Tuesday

The Steadfast Way

A man’s life gets decided on the days nobody photographs.

IN THIS SESSION

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What we talked about

The session in one paragraph, the big idea, and the lines worth keeping.

WHERE YOU USE IT

Before and after the session

SESSION 1 IN BRIEF

What we talked about

A man’s life gets decided on the days nobody photographs, the plain days Wes calls Tuesday. Wes told his daughter they would fix her soft bike tire together after supper, then opened the laptop for one thing and ended up fixing it alone in the dark. He did the job and missed the girl, and that is being gone, dressed up as competence. An older man once asked Wes what he did yesterday, listened to the list, and said, “I didn’t ask what you finished. I asked where you were.” When Glenn left his phone in the car, his boy started looking over again, and when Howard went to his grandson’s school project, he found out the work of being a man hadn’t clocked out with the job. So walk out of here with one small yes that will still be standing when the feeling leaves.

THE BIG IDEA

A man’s life gets decided on the days nobody photographs.

WORTH REMEMBERING

<i>“A habit is what repeated work leaves on a man.”</i>	<i>“The feeling is a poor foreman. It will not show up and run the job.”</i>	<i>“A move you can fail at is the only kind that can make a man.”</i>
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Companion reading: *Steadfast Men*, the Introduction and Chapter 1, *A Quiet Tuesday*.

HOW TO USE THIS WORKBOOK

IN THE ROOM Keep this open while Wes teaches. A few pages ask you to write something down on the spot.	AT YOUR TABLE Work the table questions with the men around you. Short and true beats long and polished.	AT HOME Take-home questions and four small moves carry you from this session to the next one.
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NOTES

The verses

Three passages, read slowly, with room to write what each one says to you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

SCRIPTURE

Three verses

Each of the three verses in this session opens one of its main points. Read them slowly. Underline the words that land.

1

LUKE 16:10 NIV

Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much, and whoever is dishonest with very little will also be dishonest with much.

A man is trusted on an ordinary day.

“Very little” is a Tuesday phrase. God trusts a man from small to large: a tone of voice when you’re tired, a message you keep sliding to tomorrow, whether you sit with your people or pass through them on the way to being useful.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

2

1 CORINTHIANS 13:11 NIV

When I was a child, I talked like a child, I thought like a child, I reasoned like a child. When I became a man, I put the ways of childhood behind me.

Put the ways of childhood behind you, on purpose.

Paul names the way he talked, thought, and reasoned. All three live on the inside. A child’s yes is real, and it lasts exactly as long as the feeling that made it. A man’s yes is still standing when the mood has left the building. A birthday doesn’t knock those ways loose. A man puts them behind him.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

3

MATTHEW 7:24 NIV

Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and puts them into practice is like a wise man who built his house on the rock.

A house does not stand on a mood.

Not “hears them and gets stirred up.” Puts them into practice. The house held in the storm because of days nobody drove past to admire. A burst feels like a new life. Practice is the life.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

The four marks

The sentence under the whole program, and the first mark this session stays on.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

THE SENTENCE UNDER THE PROGRAM

The four marks

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

1THIS SESSION
STOP WAITING*When it's yours to do, start now, before you feel like it.***2**COMING
PICK UP THE WEIGHT*Carry what's yours, even when somebody else dropped it.***3**COMING
GO FIRST*Step out ahead of your people, scared or not.***4**COMING
WORK FOR GOD'S PAY*Do it for the Lord's reward, not the room's applause.*

Four verbs. Not one of them is a mood you wait on, and the first one tells you to stop waiting. This session stays on the first. If you try to swallow all four before you stand up, you leave with a speech and no practice.

WRITE IT IN YOUR OWN HAND

Don't swap a word to make it sound more like you. It doesn't need the help.

REST, OR VANISHING?**Rest is a gift**

- A nap is allowed.
- A quiet evening is a gift.
- Sleep, some nights, is the faithful thing.

Vanishing is not rest

- Being absent from what's yours while you are busy with something else.
- Leaving, and calling the leaving peace.
- Keeping the expectations small and calling it peace.

Honest check. Which one were most of your evenings last week?

This sentence is how Steadfast Men defines a man. Chapter 3, The Four Marks, lays it out, and Chapters 4 to 7 take the marks one at a time. Stop Waiting is Chapter 4.

In the room

Two short writing moments while Wes teaches, and space for your notes.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

DURING THE SESSION

In the room

We will stop a couple of times and ask you to write. Use this page. Nobody else needs to see it.

ONE WORD

We asked you to look at your hands. Yesterday they were busy. Find one thing they did that a person in your life could not have hired out. Not a task. A presence. If nothing honest comes, don't dress it up. Write one word in the box. Gone. Phone. Work. Later. Easy. Whatever the true word is. Don't show your neighbor. We come back to it.

MY ONE WORD

Later in the session, Jesus' phrase "very little" comes back around. That word is very little. It won't impress a stranger. It is what tells on a man when the stakes grow up.

WHAT YOUR HANDS DID

If something honest did come: what did your hands do yesterday that nobody could have hired out? If the house is just you, think of somebody you are still responsible to love.

NOTES FROM THE TALK

LINES THAT LANDED, QUESTIONS, ANYTHING YOU WANT TO KEEP

At the tables

Four questions and one move, worked with the men around you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At your table

WORK THIS PART TOGETHER

At the tables

Two rules. Don't explain the chapter to each other. Don't rescue a man from the question with advice.

1 Where in your ordinary days do you keep an aisle instead of a seat?

You were in the building. Were you in the room?

2 What cover is closest right now?

Name your cover. Leave your neighbor's alone.

☐ Living on options ☐ Hiding inside a good job ☐ Treating some later season as the real start

3 Who in reach already knows if you showed up last Tuesday?

If you can't think of a name, that answer is an answer.

4 Say this out loud, in one sentence: where did you disappear last Tuesday without calling it that?

Say it first. Then write it.

5 Then write the move. Not a speech.

One meal with the phone in another room, and one small yes that will still be there if the feeling leaves.

MY NEXT MOVE ON A TUESDAY IS

THE LINE FOR YOUR HANDWRITING. WRITE IT ONCE.

"Tuesday is where a man is made, or he settles."

Take home

Work on this during the week. Eight questions, four small moves, and what to bring to Session 2.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At home, between now and Session 2

IN THIS SECTION

Reflection questions 1 to 4	13
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TAKE HOME

Reflection questions

Work on these during the week. Take one or two a night. Answer on the day you actually have, not the one you wish you had.

1 THE BIKE IN THE DARK

Where, lately, did you do the job and miss the person? What did it cost them? What did it cost you?

2 THE WEATHER REPORT

Is there a true sentence you've been carrying and sanding down to "long day"? Who is it owed to? Write the true version here, the one that would cost you.

3 WHERE WERE YOU

Answer the older man's question about yesterday. What did you do that the people in your life could not have hired out? Not a task. A presence.

4 WAITING ON A FEELING

What have you been waiting to feel before you start? What later season have you been treating as the real start: a wife, a better job, a quieter house, the day you retire?

TAKE HOME

Reflection questions, continued

5 THE SIDELINE

What is your phone on the sideline, the thing that keeps you in the building and out of the room? Is there someone in your life who has stopped looking over?

6 REST OR VANISHING

Look honestly at your evenings. Where are you resting, and where are you leaving and calling it peace? If you're barely holding on, hear an invitation, not a whip. If you're comfortable, don't borrow the other man's excuse.

7 VERY LITTLE

Look at the one word you wrote in the room. If Jesus is right that very little tells on a man when the stakes grow up, what is your word telling on?

8 AN HONEST DAY

If you trust Christ, you are not manufacturing manhood to win a room; a Father has already claimed you. If you aren't sure about Him yet, start with an honest day. What would you tell God about last Tuesday if you told Him all of it?

TAKE HOME · BETWEEN NOW AND SESSION 2

This week

Four small moves. Small on purpose. A move you can fail at is the only kind that can make a man.

1

Eat one meal with the phone in another room.

Not in your pocket, where it can buzz you out of your own life. Another room. If you live alone, you still sit down, and the phone still leaves.

DAY _____ WHO WAS AT THE TABLE _____

WHAT I NOTICED _____

☐ Done

2

Keep one small yes.

Pick one yes small enough to do after the feeling has gone home. Write it down before the day starts. Not a speech. A move you could fail at.

MY SMALL YES _____ DAY _____

WHERE IT HELD OR SLIPPED _____

☐ It held ☐ It slipped

3

Text one man about his Tuesday.

Ask him what he did with his Tuesday. Let him ask you the same. Send it before you walk out of the room today, if you can. Try: "What did you do with your Tuesday? Ask me the same."

HIS NAME _____ SENT ON _____

☐ Sent

4

Answer the question on one plain night.

Before bed on one ordinary evening, write one line. Not what you finished. Where you were.

WHERE WAS I TODAY? _____

CARRY THIS

"Tuesday is where a man is made, or he settles."

TAKE HOME

Bring this to Session 2

Come ready to say one sentence at your table about each of these.

1 The meal happened on

Day, and who was at the table

2 The man I texted

His name, and the day you sent it

3 My small yes, and how it went

Where it held, or where it slipped

4 What he said about his Tuesday

And what you told him about yours

5 Where I was, on the plain night

The one line you wrote before bed

NEXT · SESSION 2

You Are Not Crazy

You were handed orders about being a man that can't both be true: from home, a job, a screen, sometimes a church. Next time we look at where the mixed orders came from, and at one sentence that can hold a man's weight.

Closing

A prayer for the week, and the charge to carry out of the room.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At the end of the session

TO CLOSE

A prayer for the week

Pray it as your own, or read it honestly and sit with it. He has never been afraid of an honest man.

Father, You were in the room on my last Tuesday, even when I wasn't. You saw where I went while I looked busy. I don't want to build a new man to impress anybody. I want to put the ways of childhood behind me because I belong to You. Give me one small yes today, and the strength to keep it after the feeling goes home. Make me a man who can be trusted with very little. Build my house on the rock, one plain day at a time. In Jesus' name, amen.

IN YOUR OWN WORDS

THE CHARGE

You came to check it out.

You sat down.

That was the first yes.

Don't waste it.

GET OUT OF THAT CHAIR, AND GO SIT WITH MEN.

STEADFAST

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SESSION 2

You Are Not Crazy

The Steadfast Way

You are not crazy for wanting one clear word about what a man is for.

IN THIS SESSION

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What we talked about

The session in one paragraph, the big idea, and the lines worth keeping.

WHERE YOU USE IT

Before and after the session

SESSION 2 IN BRIEF

What we talked about

You were handed orders about being a man that fight each other, and you are not crazy for wanting one clear word about what a man is for. Wes tried to obey two men on the same night, staying late for one and coming home loud and helpful for the other, and neither of them lived in his house. Paul names every wind of teaching, and a boat getting thrown around doesn't mean the boat is crazy. When the orders won't agree, men hide like the first man in the garden, by waiting, by performing, and by carrying shame for a contradiction they didn't write, the way Hank carried two lines in his wallet that were never going to shake hands. But before any of that, God made a man on purpose, and He wasn't guessing. So own both, name the orders that fought and own the part that's yours, then say your one sentence out loud to a man who'll say his back.

THE BIG IDEA

You are not crazy for wanting one clear word about what a man is for.

WHAT THE FIGHT DOES TO A MAN

HIDES BY WAITING

If every direction has been scolded by somebody, standing still starts to look polite. Careful can be a stall with a clean shirt on.

COVERS BY PERFORMING

You start fitting whatever room you're standing in. A rented man goes back at the end of the day.

CARRIES SHAME

A good man prosecuting himself for a contradiction he didn't write, and calling it realistic.

WORTH REMEMBERING

"You're not confused because you're slow. You're confused because you were listening."

"He didn't need my speech. He needed the truth in a smaller size."

"He got a pile. He needed a path."

Companion reading: Steadfast Men, Chapter 2, You Are Not Crazy.

NOTES

The verses

Three passages, read slowly, with room to write what each one says to you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

SCRIPTURE

Three verses

Each of the three verses in this session opens one of its main points. Read them slowly. Underline the words that land.

1

EPHESIANS 4:14 NIV

Then we will no longer be infants, tossed back and forth by the waves, and blown here and there by every wind of teaching and by the cunning and craftiness of people in their deceitful scheming.

A boat getting thrown around doesn't mean the boat is crazy.

Paul doesn't pretend the wind isn't blowing. He names it. And notice who gets tossed. It isn't a wicked man. It's an infant, a man nobody finished raising. It means there's weather.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

2

GENESIS 3:10 NIV

He answered, "I heard you in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid."

Afraid, and covered, and hid.

That's the first man, right after the first wrong turn. God comes walking in the cool of the day, calling for him. That's still what men do when the orders won't agree.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

3

GENESIS 1:27 NIV

So God created mankind in his own image, in the image of God he created them; male and female he created them.

He wasn't guessing.

Created. Not assembled by committee. Not left to chance. The man had no résumé yet, and God called the making good anyway. Being a man is not a costume you try on. It was His idea.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

Own both

Pick Up the Weight, the one mark this session leans on. Part of the gap is yours, and part of it was handed to you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

THE MARK IN FOCUS

Pick Up the Weight

IN WES'S WORDS

Own both

Part of the gap is yours. Part of it was handed to you. You have to own both.

A man will want to skip this part. Keep both on the table. One will try to swallow the other. Don't let it.

OWN BOTH

Name the orders

Where the orders fought, name the orders.

Own the part that's yours

Where you checked out, say so.

TWO WAYS TO DODGE IT

The blanket

- You only own the world's part.
- The confusion turns into a hiding place.
- A hiding place with a humble sign on the door.

The stick

- You plead guilty to the whole mess.
- You confess to being broken, when mostly you were worn out by a contradiction.
- Swinging at yourself with somebody else's stick.

Honest check. Some men do both in the same afternoon. Blame everybody at lunch, and blame themselves by supper. Which one do you reach for first?

☐ The blanket ☐ The stick ☐ Both, same afternoon

This mark is one of four in the sentence the whole program stands on: a steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's. In the book's words, Pick Up the Weight means carry what's yours, even when somebody else dropped it, once it lands in your house or your lane. Session 3 opens the whole sentence up. Companion reading for this mark: Steadfast Men, Chapter 5, Pick Up the Weight.

In the room

Two short writing moments while Wes teaches, and space for your notes.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

DURING THE SESSION

In the room

Wes will ask for a couple of hands and tell a few stories about orders that fight. Use this page while he talks. Nobody else needs to see it.

TWO VOICES

Wes bets that on some ordinary day you meant to say the small yes, and one voice in your head said, do it this way, while another said, no, a man worth the name does the opposite. Write down what each voice said.

ONE VOICE SAID

THE OTHER VOICE SAID

Tuesday in one hand, two sets of orders in the other.

HANDS UP

Wes asks two questions for a show of hands. Check the ones that are true for you.

- ☐ I can name two instructions about being a man that can't both be true.
- ☐ I've gone quiet because quiet felt safer than picking a side.

If you can name two orders that fight, you're not confused because you're slow. You're confused because you were listening.

NOTES FROM THE TALK

LINES THAT LANDED, QUESTIONS, ANYTHING YOU WANT TO KEEP

At the tables

Three questions and one sentence, worked with the men around you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At your table

WORK THIS PART TOGETHER

At the tables

Before you start. Don't polish it. Ugly and true will do. Don't explain the chapter to each other. Don't rescue a man from the question with advice. Advice can be a nice way to leave.

- 1 Name two instructions you were handed about being a man that contradict each other. Where did each one come from?**

Home. A job. A screen. A church. A buddy. One sentence each.

INSTRUCTION ONE _____

IT CAME FROM _____

INSTRUCTION TWO _____

IT CAME FROM _____

- 2 Which one is closer right now?**

Say the true one. Not the flattering one.

☐ I wait ☐ I perform for the room ☐ I carry a quiet hum of shame

- 3 In one sentence, what do you believe a man is supposed to do?**

Don't write the one you wish. Write the one you'd say if nobody was grading you.

- 4 Then read it to a brother at your table. Ask for his.**

Don't explain first. Explaining is how a man hides.

HIS NAME _____

HIS SENTENCE _____

Doing this by yourself? You still write the sentence today, and you still read it to one man. A private project you mean to finish later is how this part dies.

THE LINE FOR YOUR HANDWRITING. WRITE IT ONCE.

"The confusion is in the world. I'm not crazy for wanting one clear word."

Take home

Eight questions, four small moves, and what to bring to Session 3.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At home, between now and Session 3

IN THIS SECTION

Reflection questions 1 to 4	31
Reflection questions 5 to 8	32
This week, four small moves	33
Bring this to Session 3	34

TAKE HOME

Reflection questions

Work on these during the week. Take one or two a night. Say the true answer, not the flattering one.

1 TWO MEN I WANTED PROUD OF ME

We stayed late for one man and came home loud and helpful for the other. Neither one lived in his house. Whose approval were you working for last week, and who actually lives in yours?

2 EVERY WIND

Most of us didn't invent the fight in our heads. We inherited it. Which order came from home, and which did you pick up on the way, from a job, a screen, a church, or a buddy?

3 HIDING BY WAITING

A dry plate, five minutes of drying, and a question about dish soap. What true sentence have you been holding at your own sink? Who has quit waiting on it?

4 THE RENTED MAN

An easy laugh with the guys, a serious nod when the talk turns heavy. Where do you match the temperature? Which room gets the man you actually are, and which gets a rented one?

TAKE HOME

Reflection questions, continued

5 HANK'S SCRAP

Two lines that were never going to shake hands. If you wrote your two lines on a scrap of paper, what would they say? Where have you been treating your own name as the charge?

6 OWN BOTH

Name one place the orders fought. Then name one place you checked out. Which do you reach for first, the blanket or the stick?

7 THE SHRUG

"Nobody really knows. Just don't be a jerk." Where have you handed a younger man a shrug instead of a sentence? What would you say to him now?

8 WHAT GOD MADE

God made a man on purpose, with no résumé yet, and called the making good. What changes if being a man is His idea and not a costume you try on?

TAKE HOME · BETWEEN NOW AND SESSION 3

This week

Four small moves. Small on purpose. Set down what God never asked you to carry, and pick up what's actually yours.

1

Name the orders

Write down the two orders about being a man that fight hardest in your life. One line each. Next to each one, write where it came from.

ORDER ONE, AND WHERE IT CAME FROM _____

ORDER TWO, AND WHERE IT CAME FROM _____

2

Own your part

Pick one place you checked out, waited, or performed. Say one true sentence about it to the person it touched. No speech. The truth in a smaller size.

WHERE I CHECKED OUT _____

THE TRUE SENTENCE I SAID _____

☐ Said it ☐ Not yet

3

Say your sentence to one man

Read your one sentence about what a man is for to one man this week, and ask for his. Don't explain first.

HIS NAME _____ DAY _____

WHAT HE SAID BACK _____

4

Set one thing down

Pick one order you've been carrying that God never asked you to carry. Set it down. Then pick up one thing that's actually yours.

SETTING DOWN _____

PICKING UP _____

CARRY THIS

"The confusion is in the world. I'm not crazy for wanting one clear word."

TAKE HOME

Bring this to Session 3

Come ready to say one sentence at your table about each of these.

1 The orders I named

Both of them, and where each one came from

2 Where I owned my part

Who heard the true sentence, and how it went

3 The man I read my sentence to

His name, and what he said back

4 What I set down

And what I picked up instead

5 My one sentence, now

What a man is for, in the words you'd stand on today

NEXT · SESSION 3

The Four Marks

You don't need a taller pile. You need one sentence that holds weight on a day when nobody's handing out credit. Next time we open the one the whole program stands on. It's simpler than the pile, and harder, because you have to live it on a flat afternoon.

Closing

A prayer for the week, and the charge to carry out of the room.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At the end of the session

TO CLOSE

A prayer for the week

Pray it as your own, or read it honestly and sit with it.

Father, You made me on purpose, and You weren't guessing. I've been handed orders that fight each other, and I've tried to obey the whole pile. I've waited, I've performed, and I've carried shame for a contradiction I didn't write. Help me set down what You never asked me to carry, and pick up what's actually mine. Where I've hidden, keep calling for me the way You called in the garden. Give me one clear word to stand on, and a brother who will say his back.

In Jesus' name, amen.

IN YOUR OWN WORDS

THE CHARGE

Set down what God never asked you to carry.

Pick up what's actually yours.

Name the orders. Own your part. Write your sentence.

Go to your tables, and tell the truth.

THEN GO SAY IT OUT LOUD TO A MAN WHO'LL SAY HIS BACK.

STEADFAST

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SESSION 3

The Four Marks

The Steadfast Way

A mark is the thing you keep doing until people can see it on you.

IN THIS SESSION

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What we talked about

The session in one paragraph, the big idea, and the lines worth keeping.

WHERE YOU USE IT

Before and after the session

SESSION 3 IN BRIEF

What we talked about

A mark is what’s left on a man by what he does over and over, like the pencil lines on Wes’s pantry door that nobody ever sees grow on a Tuesday. Of the four marks, this session stayed with the one men skip, working for God’s pay, the inheritance a Father keeps for His sons, and not the room’s. Hebrews 11:6 says God exists and rewards those who earnestly seek Him, and if His reward isn’t the one you’re after, you’ll go collect one somewhere else, the way Wes hovered in the kitchen waiting for his daughter to notice a desk. Lonnie drove his dad to dialysis for four years almost nobody noticed, until one dark morning in the clinic lot it hit him that One does. Jesus says your Father sees what’s done behind the door, and Paul says the harvest comes at the proper time if we don’t give up. So quit fishing for the receipt, do one good thing a day you never mention, and let your Father, who sees what’s done in secret, be the one who rewards you.

THE BIG IDEA

A mark is the thing you keep doing until people can see it on you.

WHAT A MARK IS, AND ISN'T

NOT A FEELING	NOT A TITLE	IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
It’s not what you feel on a good morning.	It’s not a title somebody hands you at a banquet.	A man who’s short with his kids at supper is making a mark too. His kids are holding the pencil.

WORTH REMEMBERING

<i>“Thanks is a gift. It just makes a lousy wage.”</i>	<i>“It doesn’t have to be big. It just has to be His.”</i>	<i>“None of it was wasted. And none of it went unseen.”</i>
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Companion reading: *Steadfast Men*, Chapter 3, *The Four Marks*, and Chapter 7, *Work for God’s Pay*.

NOTES

The verses

Three passages, read slowly, with room to write what each one says to you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

SCRIPTURE

Three verses

Each of the three verses in this session opens one of its main points. Read them slowly. Underline the words that land.

1

HEBREWS 11:6 NIV

And without faith it is impossible to please God, because anyone who comes to him must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who earnestly seek him.

Not maybe. Must.

Two things. That He is, and that He rewards. Most men would sign the first one without blinking. It's the second one we get funny about. The verse doesn't blush. A man who comes to God has to believe God rewards.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

2

MATTHEW 6:6 NIV

But when you pray, go into your room, close the door and pray to your Father, who is unseen. Then your Father, who sees what is done in secret, will reward you.

Your Father sees. And your Father rewards.

Jesus just assumes you've got a life behind a door, a part nobody claps for, and He doesn't treat it like second string. The door is not a hiding place. This is closing the door on what you did right, so the only one who rewards it is your Father.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

3

GALATIANS 6:9 NIV

Let us not become weary in doing good, for at the proper time we will reap a harvest if we do not give up.

Tired isn't the end of the story.

Paul says weary like he's met you. Doing good gets old. Not bad. Old. And he doesn't say right away. He says at the proper time, which means not your time. The whole condition is that you don't quit.

WHAT THIS VERSE SAYS TO ME

The four marks

What a mark is, the four in plain words, and a card to write them on.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room, then on your visor

FOUR HANDLES

The four marks

The whole thing hangs on one word. Miss it, and the four turn into a poster.

A mark is what's left on a man by what he does over and over.

1 ITS OWN DAY STOP WAITING <i>When it's yours to do, start now, before you feel like it.</i>	2 ITS OWN DAY PICK UP THE WEIGHT <i>Carry what's yours, even when somebody else dropped it.</i>	3 ITS OWN DAY GO FIRST <i>Step out ahead of your people, scared or not.</i>	4 THIS SESSION WORK FOR GOD'S PAY <i>Do it for the Lord's reward, not the room's applause.</i>
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Four marks. Every one of them is something you do. Not one of them is a feeling you wait for. You can't get a mark by agreeing with Wes. You get one by doing it on a day you don't want to.

WRITE THE FOUR ON A CARD

A steadfast man stops waiting, picks up the weight, goes first, and works for God's pay, not the room's.

In your own hand. Copy the sentence onto a card and put it on the visor, the mirror, the dash. Somewhere a plain morning will find it.

MY FOUR

THE PANTRY DOOR

The people closest to a mark are the last ones to notice. If somebody who lives with you opened the door on this year, what would they see?

Behind the door

The fourth mark, the one men skip. Work for God's Pay, not the room's.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

THE MARK IN FOCUS

Work for God's Pay

THE FOURTH MARK

God's pay, not the room's

Do it for the Lord's reward, not the room's applause.

A decent man can do the first three for a long time without God in it at all. The fourth is where you find out who a man is actually working for. Every man works for some kind of pay. The question is whose.

Hear the word “pay” the way Paul meant it. God's pay is an inheritance, what a Father gives His sons because they're His. Nobody earns an inheritance. In Christ you're a son by grace before you've lifted a finger, so you work like a son because you already are one.

WHO'S PAYING YOU?

Where I collect it now

- The guy you report to
- A good review
- The group text
- A nod from your brother-in-law

What I'd do behind the door

One good thing nobody would ever pay you for.

FISHING FOR THE RECEIPT

Check the ones that sound like you. If you need the good thing to be seen, you'll find a way to be seen doing it.

- ☐ I mention it. Kind of sideways.
- ☐ I stack the chairs a little louder than I need to.
- ☐ I hover, waiting for somebody to find it.
- ☐ I feel great for about ten minutes.

Why this one holds the others up. Every other mark will cost you on a day nobody says thank you. Without the fourth, those are just good habits. And good habits quit when the pay stops.

Honest check. Where did you grab the nod over supper this month, and trade away what the Father was keeping for you?

In the room

A show of hands, a hand you keep in your lap, and space for your notes.

WHERE YOU USE IT

In the room

DURING THE SESSION

In the room

Wes asks for one hand and tells you to keep the other one down. Use this page while he talks. Nobody else needs to see it.

HOVERING

Wes asks how many of you have fixed something and then hung around waiting for somebody to find it.

☐ That's me. I've done some hovering.

It looks exactly like a good dad. It just runs out a lot faster.

KEEP IT DOWN

Then he asks who did something good this month that nobody knows about, and tells you not to raise your hand. Don't write it here either. Just check the box, and keep the rest between you and your Father.

☐ Yes. And I'm keeping it down.

That's the fourth mark. Right there. The hand you just kept in your lap.

NOTES FROM THE TALK

THE PANTRY DOOR, THE DESK, LONNIE, THE RECEIPT. LINES THAT LANDED, ANYTHING YOU WANT TO KEEP

At the tables

Three questions and the line for your handwriting, worked with the men around you.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At your table

WORK THIS PART TOGETHER

At the tables

Before you start. Don't explain the chapter to each other. Don't talk a man out of his answer. Let it sit there a minute. Nobody at your table needs a good answer. They need your real one. If the man next to you says something true, don't fix it. Just thank him. That kind of thanks is allowed.

1 Which of the four marks is faintest on you right now, and why?

A full sentence. Not the one that makes you sound humble. The one that actually fits. If you picked the fourth one with Wes, pull up a chair. It's a big table.

☐ 1. Stop Waiting ☐ 2. Pick Up the Weight ☐ 3. Go First ☐ 4. Work for God's Pay

2 Where would those four have to work, on an actual person, or they're only a hobby?

Give it a name. A face. Your wife. Your roommate. The guy at work who gets under your skin.

NAME

WHERE THE FOUR WOULD HAVE TO WORK

3 If a brother at your table named a different faint mark for you, would you look again?

Let him finish. Then answer.

HE NAMED

MY ANSWER

Doing this by yourself? You still name it today, and you still tell one man.

THE LINE FOR YOUR HANDWRITING. WRITE IT ONCE.

"Nobody saw it. My Father did."

Then do one good thing before the day's out, and tell nobody. Not your wife. Not the guys. Not Wes.

Take home

Eight questions, four small moves, and what to bring to Session 4.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At home, between now and Session 4

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TAKE HOME

Reflection questions

Work on these during the week. Take one or two a night. Nobody needs a good answer. Write your real one.

1 THE PENCIL LINE

What have you done over and over this year? If somebody who lives with you opened the pantry door on it, would they see six inches of the right thing, or the wrong thing?

2 HE REWARDS

You'd sign "God exists" without blinking. What about "he rewards"? Where do you get funny about that second half?

3 WHO'S PAYING YOU

Thanks is a gift. It just makes a lousy wage. Whose thanks have you been working for, and what happens to your effort when it stops coming?

4 THE DESK

Where did you hover this month, waiting for somebody to find the thing you did? What were you hoping to be paid?

TAKE HOME

Reflection questions, continued

5 LONNIE'S LOT

Where are you the only one who knows you're doing it? What changes if you believe One does?

6 BEHIND THE DOOR

A kitchen at five-thirty. The drive home. The apology nobody knew you owed. The screen you didn't open. Name one door in your week. What happens behind it?

7 THE RECEIPT

How do you fish? Where have you settled for a nod over supper, and traded away what the Father was keeping for you?

8 THE PROPER TIME

What good thing have you grown weary of doing? What would it mean to keep going, and let the proper time be His to pick?

TAKE HOME · BETWEEN NOW AND SESSION 4

This week

Four small moves. Start small. It'll feel like the good is going to waste. It isn't. Your Father sees it, and He keeps an inheritance for His sons.

1

One good thing a day, never mentioned

Do one good thing a day that you never mention. Not even sideways. Not at supper. Not in the group text.

Check the day. Don't write down what it was.

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

2

Write the four on a card

In your own hand. Put it where a plain morning will find it.

☐ Visor ☐ Mirror ☐ The dash ☐ Somewhere else

3

Hold your faintest mark

Not all four. One. Find the one that's faintest on you, hold it for a while, and tell one man which one it is.

MY FAINTEST MARK _____

THE MAN I TOLD _____

DAY _____

4

Don't give up on one good thing

Pick the good thing you've grown weary of, or the prayer that feels like it's hitting the ceiling. Keep at it every day this week.

THE THING I WON'T QUIT _____

☐ Mon ☐ Tue ☐ Wed ☐ Thu ☐ Fri ☐ Sat ☐ Sun

CARRY THIS

"Nobody saw it. My Father did."

TAKE HOME

Bring this to Session 4

Come ready to say one sentence at your table about each of these.

1 The faintest mark I named

And the man who heard it

2 Where my card lives

And whether a plain morning found it

3 What it was like not to mention it

Not what you did. Keep that behind the door. Just what leaving it there was like.

4 The person the four had to work on

The name you gave at your table, and one moment this week

5 The good I didn't quit

Where you got weary, and kept going anyway

NEXT · SESSION 4

Stop Waiting

Each of the four marks gets a day of its own. Next time we start with the first one, Stop Waiting. When it's yours to do, start now, before you feel like it.

Closing

A prayer for the work nobody sees, and the charge for this week.

WHERE YOU USE IT

At the end of the session

TO CLOSE

A prayer for the work nobody sees

Pray it behind a closed door if you can. He's already there.

Father, I believe You exist. Help me believe You reward the ones who seek You. I've done good and then gone looking for the receipt. I've hovered, and fished, and stacked the chairs loud. Thank You that You saw the early drives and the late nights, and that none of it was wasted. Teach me to close the door, do the good, and let You be the one who rewards me. I'm Your son, and what You keep for me is an inheritance, not a wage. When I get weary, hold me to the proper time. In Jesus' name, amen.

IN YOUR OWN WORDS

THE CHARGE

*Quit fishing for the receipt.
Close the door. Do the good.
Let your Father be the one who rewards you.
Give your Father something to see.*

ONE GOOD THING BEFORE THE DAY'S OUT. TELL NOBODY.